

GAME CHANGER

Sanjay Jalona has helped LTI grow by creating a niche, through acquisitions, and by exiting from some sectors

By Nidhi Singal



BUY TO GROW Sanjay Jalona, CEO & MD, L&T Infotech

► **WHEN SANJAY JALONA**, an Infosys veteran, took over as CEO & MD of LTI in 2015 (known as Larsen and Toubro Infotech back then), he had a simple mandate—take charge of the business and create a unique place for the brand. Over the years, with the right strategy and focus, he has managed to achieve just that.

Jalona decided to focus on fewer sectors and let go of sectors the company did not have a competitive advantage in. “We can never compete with an Accenture or a TCS in banking. They will be many times... [bigger than] my company... But we can compete in some areas, verticals and niches. We have to be able to compete with everyone,” explains Jalona. This inordinate focus has helped LTI build capabilities and turn competitive.

The company has incubated some new verticals and utilities in India, the US and Europe. “This has helped us reach where we are. We have built deep digital capabilities and an enviable culture of client-centric innovation,” says Jalona, the winner in the IT & ITeS category of the *BT-PwC India’s Best CEOs* ranking.

In addition to its rapid organic growth, LTI has developed an acquisitions-led growth strategy to expand the breadth and depth of its services. It has completed seven acquisitions under Jalona’s leadership: AugmentIQ Data Sciences, an innovative start-up offering IP-based, big data and analytics solutions; Luxembourg-based

Key Highlights

- ❶ Sanjay Jalona decided to focus on fewer sectors and let go of sectors LTI did not have a competitive advantage in
- ❷ This focus has helped the company build capabilities and turn competitive
- ❸ LTI has developed an acquisitions-led growth strategy and has completed seven acquisitions
- ❹ Data, cloud and digital account for 53 per cent of the business today
- ❺ LTI is focussed on building talent at scale and has increased total headcount by 31 per cent year-on-year